Stat 371 Practice Problem Session #5

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Today's Topics:

1. Sampling Distributions
2. Central Limit Theorem

1. Sampling Distributions

One of the harder concepts in statistics is that of the sampling distribution.

a. What do we mean by a "sampling distribution"? Come up with an example involving binomial random variables, making sure to identify the parameter of interest and what the sampling distribution could look like.

b. What does the Central Limit Theorem (CLT) say about the sampling distribution for sample mean / sample proportion? Use this to say something about your example from part (a).

c. Why might it be helpful to study the distribution of a sample mean / proportion? What can it tell us about our problem? (come back to this at the end if you aren't sure yet. These problems will you show you some applications)

2. Typical Coin Counts

Recall the central limit theorem: If $\bar{X} \sim_{approx} N(\mu, (\sigma/\sqrt{n})^2)$ where $se = \sigma/\sqrt{n}$ is called the standard error

a. First we'll seem some examples of the CLT in action. The "rbinom" function samples randomly and independently from the binomial distribution. Try running the code below for N = 10, 100, 1000, 10000. Explain what's happening to the sampling distribution as your sample size N grows bigger. Interpret this if we think about this in the case of flipping a biased coin.

In [ ]:
```
N =
samples <- rbinom(n = 1000, size = N, prob = 0.3)/N
hist(samples, main = "Sampling Distribution from Binomial Distribution
```

b. Describe the distribution of the number of heads from flipping 10, 100, 500, and 1000 flips of a *fair* coin. Plot the histograms of the sample proporition of heads for N = 1000 expirements for each of the four scenarios describes above.

c. Re-run the code above with p=0.1 and compare the results with the histograms from previous part. What distribution do these histograms resemble?

d. This is a neat observation, but why should anyone care? If we know the distribution of our sample proportion/mean, then we can say things about the likelyhood of seeing certain values!

Use the CLT to approximate the probability that you'll see more than 600 heads from 1000 flips of a fair coin. Compare the results to the exact calculations using pbinom()

e. One of the reasons we care so much about the CLT is because it helps us doing hypothesis testing. Suppose you want to test whether a coin is fair. The way we construct hypothesis tests is we determine 'extreme' head counts that would be exceedingly unlikely.

Use qnorm to find the number of heads H such that $P(\#\text{ Heads Observed} \geq H) \leq 0.05$. Compare the result to the exact value using qbinom(). If we 'reject' the hypothesis that a fair coin

3. White Nile Frogs

Some scientists are collecting data on the dimensions of the Xenopus (African clawed frog) from the White Nile River. The scientists collect the following data describing the lengths of the frogs:

15, 19, 8, 12, 16, 12, 14, 12, 14, 13, 15, 12, 9, 17, 18, 20, 12, 15, 18, 21, 8, 10, 12, 14, 17, 18, 20, 20, 21, 11, 12, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 9, 11, 10, 10, 11, 12, 14, 14, 19, 10, 9, 11, 16, 9, 8, 10, 11, 12

a. Calculate the the sample mean and standard error of frog sizes.

b. Use the CLT to describe the approximate distribution of the sample mean.

c. Use this approximate distribution to estimate the probability that $P(10 \leq \bar{X} \leq 20)$

d. Some locals claim the frogs in the While Nile are smaller than those in a nearby pond. The scientists conduct a census of the small pond and find that the mean length of frogs in that pond is exactly 20.78 cm. What's $P(\bar{X} > 20.51)$? Does

the claim of the locals seem reasonable?

4. Painting the big picture

Two important big picture ideas about statistics and probability are listed below along with a graphical representation. For each statement, describe a *different* example scenario involving binomial random variables (instead of normal random variables) that emphasizes the point of the statement.

a. Probability theory describes how likely we will see quantities of samples (like averages or proportions) in random samples of a population given an underlying distribution. For example, if we know that crab claw length is approximately normally distributed with $\mu = 5, \sigma^2 = 1$, then the 68-95-99.7 rule tells us that we will see very few (0.03%) crabs with claw length over 3 standard deviations away from μ, or $\mu \pm 3 * \sigma = 2, 8$.

b. Statistics is the reverse problem: it studies how we can learn about the underlying distribution of the population given a sample. For example, if we know that crab claw lengths are approximately normally distributed, then we can just try to estimate the mean and standard deviation to describe the distribution of crabs.

